- Is certified by Medicare as such, or is licensed or accredited as such, by the jurisdiction it is in;
- Is supervised by a staff of M.D.'s or D.O.'s, at least one of whom must be on call at all times;
- Provides 24-hour-a-day nursing services under the direction of an R.N. and has a full-time administrator; and
- Provides an ongoing quality assurance program.

- Skilled Nursing Facility licensed by the state or certified by Medicare if the state does not license these facilities. See limitations in Section 5(c), *Services Provided by a Hospital or Other Facility, and Ambulance Services*.
- Birth Center
  - A birth center is a health facility that is not a hospital or physician's office, where childbirth is planned to occur away from the pregnant woman's residence, that is licensed or otherwise approved by the state to provide prenatal, labor and delivery, or postpartum care that is covered by the plan.
- Residential Treatment Centers (RTCs)
  - An institution that is primarily engaged in providing: (1) 24-hour residential evaluation, treatment, and comprehensive specialized services relating to the individual's specific mental health, and/or substance use disorder therapy needs, all under the active participation and direction of a licensed physician who is practicing within the scope of the physician's license; and (2) specialized programs for persons who need short-term services designed to achieve predicted outcomes focused on fostering improvement or stability in mental health and/or substance use disorder, recognizing the individuality, strengths, and needs of the persons served; and (3) care that meets evidence-based treatment guidelines or criteria as determined by the plan.
  - The services are provided for a fee from its patients and include both: (1) room and board; and (2) 24-hour-a-day registered nursing services. Additionally, the RTC keeps adequate patient records which include: (1) the individualized treatment plan; and (2) the person's progress; and (3) discharge summary; and (4) follow-up programs. Benefits are available for services performed and billed by RTCs, as described in Section 5(e), *Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder Benefits*.
  - RTCs must be: (1) operated pursuant to law; and (2) accredited by a nationally recognized organization, and licensed by the state, district or territory to provide residential treatment for mental health conditions and/or substance use disorder; or (3) credentialed by a network partner.
  - The term RTC does not include a convalescent home, extended care facility, skilled nursing facility, group home, halfway house, sober home, transitional living center or treatment, or any institution or part thereof which: (1) is used principally as a convalescent facility, nursing facility, or long-term care; (2) furnishes primarily domiciliary or custodial care, including training in the routines of daily living; or (3) is operating or licensed as a school.

- **Transitional care**

Specialty care: You may continue seeing your specialist and receiving any PPO benefits for up to 90 days if you are undergoing treatment for a chronic or disabling condition and you lose access to your specialist because:

- we drop out of the Federal Employees Health Benefits (FEHB) Program and you enroll in another FEHB Plan, or
- we terminate our contract with your specialist for reasons other than for cause.

Contact us at 800-821-6136 or, if we drop out of the Program, contact your new plan.